

Culture

*A way to organize people with
shared values*



What is culture?

- ✓ Culture refers to the cumulative deposit of knowledge, experience, beliefs, values, attitudes, meanings, hierarchies, religion, notions of time, roles, spatial relations, concepts of the universe, and material objects and possessions acquired by a group of people in the course of generations through individual and group striving.
- ✓ Culture is the systems of knowledge shared by a relatively large group of people.
- ✓ Culture is communication, communication is culture.
- ✓ Culture in its broadest sense is cultivated behavior; that is the totality of a person's learned, accumulated experience which is socially transmitted, or more briefly, behavior through social learning.
- ✓ In short, A culture is a way of life of a group of people--the behaviors, beliefs, values, and symbols that they accept, generally without thinking about them, and that are passed along by communication and imitation from one generation to the next.

Features of culture

- Culture is learnt
 - It is social
- Culture is shared
 - Transmissive
- Continuous and cumulative
 - Dynamic and adapted
- Cultures vary from society to society

Types of culture

Material Culture

- ❑ Material culture includes the objects associated with a cultural group, such as tools, machines, utensils, buildings, and artwork.



NON-MATERIAL CULTURE



Non tangible and
non-observable

Non-material culture consists of the words the people use or the language they speak, the belief they hold, values and virtues they cherish, habits they follow, rituals and practices that they do and the ceremonies they observed. It also includes our customs and tastes, attitudes and outlooks.

Layers of culture

People even within the same culture carry several layers of mental programming within themselves. Different layers of culture exist at the following levels:

- The national level: Associated with the nation as a whole.
- The regional level: Associated with ethnic, linguistic, or religious differences that exist within a nation.
- The gender level: Associated with gender differences (female vs. male)
- The generation level: Associated with the differences between grandparents and parents, parents and children.
- Family Level, Personal Level
- The social class level: Associated with educational opportunities and differences in occupation.
- The corporate level: Associated with the particular culture of an organization. Applicable to those who are employed.

Elements of culture



Cultural lag & Cultural Conflict:

- “Cultural lag” refers to the phenomenon where a society's non-material culture (values, beliefs, norms) struggles to keep pace with changes in its material culture (technology, tools), leading to a disconnect and potential social conflict. **Example:** the early days of automobiles when roads and traffic laws were not yet adjusted to accommodate cars, leading to confusion and accidents,
- “Cultural conflict” describes the clashes that arise when different cultural groups within a society have conflicting values, practices, or interests, often due to power imbalances or competing norms. **Example:** In a diverse culture, clashes between different religious groups regarding practices like food restrictions, clothing choices, or holiday celebrations can lead to cultural conflict.

Social Processes

- **Social processes** are how individuals and groups interact, adjust, readjust, and establish relationships and patterns of behavior which are again modified through **social interactions**.
- Social processes are the patterned interactions and behaviors that shape the structure of society. They refer to how individuals and groups influence each other and the social norms, institutions, and systems that evolve from these interactions.
- Examples: Changes in societal institutions, how movements (like civil rights) evolve, or how social networks influence behavior.

Social Interaction

- Man is a social animal. It is difficult for him to live in isolation. They always live in groups. As members of these groups, they act in a certain manner. Their behavior is mutually affected. This interaction or mutual activity is the essence of social life. Social life is not possible without interactions.
- Social interactions are reciprocal relationships that influence the interacting individuals and the quality of relationships.
- Eldredge and Merrill say, “Social interaction is thus the general process whereby two or more persons are in meaningful contact-as a result of which their behavior is modified, however, slightly”.

Social Interaction

- When the interacting individuals or groups influence the behavior of each other it is called social interaction. People in action with one another means interaction of some kind. But not every kind of action is social.
- When people and their attitudes are involved, the process becomes social. Social interaction may then be defined as that dynamic interplay of forces in which contact between persons and groups results in a modification of the attitudes and behavior of the participants.

✂ Any conversation, be it a lengthy conversation between intimate friends or casual chatter around the office water cooler, is a social interaction. Social interactions can also be nonverbal, like eye contact made between two people.



The two basic conditions of social interaction are

- (i) social contact and
- (ii) communication.

The means of communication are essential adjuncts of social contact. Communication may be the form of direct person to person or it may take place through some medium of long-range contact such as the telephone, telegraph, television, etc.

Social interaction usually takes place in the forms of cooperation, competition, conflict, accommodation, and assimilation. These forms of social interaction are called “social processes”.

Classification of social process

- Social process may be classified in three ways as under:

1. By the number of persons involved, i.e., one-with-one; one-with- group; and its reverse, group-with-one, and group-with-group.
2. By the degree of intimacy of the individual and groups in interaction. For example, primary, secondary and tertiary or marginal groups.
3. By the nature or types of the processes

- These processes may be grouped into two main categories:

(1) integrative/conjunctive/associative, and

(2) disintegrative/disjunctive/ dissociative.

Associative Process

1. Co-operation
2. Accommodation
3. Assimilation
4. Acculturation

Dissociative Process

1. Conflict
2. Competition
3. Isolation
4. Differentiation

Cooperation

- The term ‘cooperation’ has been derived from two Latin words – ‘Co’ meaning ‘together’ and ‘Operary’ meaning ‘to work’. Hence, cooperation means working together for the achievement of a common goal or goals. When two or more persons work together to gain a common goal, it is called cooperation. Boys cooperate in games, men in business, workers in production, public officials in community controls, and so on, in an endless variety of beneficial activities that make possible an integrated social life.
- It is defined by Green as “the continuous and common Endeavour of two or more persons to perform a task or to reach a goal that is commonly cherished.

Characteristics of cooperation:

- 1) it takes place between two or more individuals or groups.
- 2) its conscious process in which individuals or groups have to work consciously.
- 3) its a personal process in which individuals and groups personally meet and work together for a common objective.
- 4) its a continuous process. There is continuity in the collective efforts in cooperation.
- 5) its a universal process which is found in all groups, societies and nations.
- 6) its based upon two elements such as common end and organized effort.
- 7) Common ends can be better achieved by cooperation and it is necessary for the progress of individual as well as society.

Classification of Cooperation

- MacIver and Page have divided cooperation into two main types namely,
 - (i) Direct Cooperation (ii) Indirect Cooperation
- A.W. Green has classified cooperation into three main categories such as
 - (i) Primary cooperation (ii) Secondary cooperation (iii) Tertiary cooperation.
- Ogburn and Nimikoff divided cooperation into three main types such as
 - i) General Cooperation (ii) Friendly Cooperation and (iii) Helping Cooperation

Accommodation:

- Adjustment is the way of life. It can take place in two ways such as adaptation and accommodation. Adaptation refers to the process of biological adjustment. Accommodation, on the other hand, implies the process of social adjustment.
- “Accommodation is the achievement of adjustment between people that permits harmonious acting together in social situations. It is achieved by an individual through the acquisition of behavior patterns, habits, and attitudes which are transmitted to him socially.
- Accommodation means adjusting oneself to the new environment.

Importance of Accommodation

- ⦿ Accommodation is the way which enable people to work together whether they like it or not.
- ⦿ Society can hardly go on without accommodation. Accommodation is essentially essential to check conflict and to maintain cooperation.
- ⦿ It not only reduces or controls conflict but also enables the individuals and groups to adjust themselves to changed conditions.
- ⦿ It is the basis of social organization.

Forms of Accommodation

Accomodation is a state of balance between cooperation and conflict.

Compromise

Each party gives up something they want in order to come to an agreement



Truce

Temporarily brings a halt to the competition or conflict until a compromise can be reached



Mediation

Calling in a third party who guides the two parties toward an agreement



Arbitration

A third party makes a decision that is binding on both parties

Methods of Accommodation

1. Admission of one's Defeat:

This method of accommodation is applicable between the conflicting parties of unequal strength. The stronger group can pressurize the weaker group by its strength. The weaker party submits to the stronger one out of fear or because of fear of being overpowered.

2. Compromise:

This method is applicable when the combatants are of equal strength. Both the combatants should make some concessions or sacrifices voluntarily for each other because they know that conflict would cause the sheer waste of their energy and resources.

3. Arbitration and Conciliation:

- Involves attempts of the third party to resolve the conflict between the contending parties.
- For example, the conflict between the employer and the employee, husband and wife, two friends, labor and management are resolved through- the intervention of an arbitrator or a conciliator or a mediator.
- Differences should, however, be noted between conciliation and arbitration.
- The conciliator offers only suggestions to terminate a conflict. The acceptance of these suggestions is up to the discretion of the contending parties.
- It has no binding force upon them. Arbitration differs from conciliation in that the decision of the arbitrator is binding on the parties concerned.

4. Toleration:

Toleration is the method of accommodation in which there is no settlement of dispute but there is only the avoidance of overt conflict or open conflict. Toleration is found in the field of religion where different religious groups exist side by side, having different policies and ideologies.

5. Conversion

one of the contending parties tries to convert his opponents to his view of point by proving that he is right and they are wrong. As a result, the party which has been convinced is likely to accept the view point of other party.

6. Rationalization:

It is a method that involves the withdrawal of a contending party from the conflict based on some imaginary explanations to justify his action. In other words, it means an individual or a group rationalizes his behavior by plausible exercises and explanations.

7. Superordination and Subordination:

The most common method of accommodation which is found in each and every society is superordination and subordination. In the family, the relationships among parents and children are based on this method. In larger groupings whether social or economic the relationships are fixed on the same basis. Even under a democratic order, there are leaders who give orders and followers who obey orders.

Assimilation:

- ◉ Assimilation is a fundamental social process; by which individuals belonging to different cultures are united into one.
- ◉ Successful accommodation sets the stage for an additional consequences of human interactions, namely assimilation.
- ◉ Assimilation is a slow and gradual process. It takes quite some time before individuals or groups once dissimilar becomes similar.



Characteristics of Assimilation

1. **Universal Process :** Assimilation as a process of integration is present in every society, all the times. So, universal in nature.
2. **Unconscious Process:** Usually the individuals or groups involved in the process of assimilation are unconscious of what is taking place. Unconsciously one assimilate himself with others.
3. **Slow and Gradual Process:** The process of assimilation cannot take place suddenly. Rather it takes time. It depends upon the nature of contacts. If it is primary, assimilation is natural and rapid. If it is secondary assimilation is slow.
4. **It is a two-way Process:** It is based on the principle of give and take. When one cultural group is in contact with another, it borrows from it certain cultural elements and incorporates them into its own culture. So it affects both.
5. **It is confined to multiple fields:** The process of assimilation is not confined to a single field but it is confined to multiple fields. In the religious field,

Influencing Factors of Assimilation

Factors favoring assimilation

- 1. Toleration**
- 2. Close Social Contact**
- 3. Amalgamation or intermarriage**
- 4. Equal Economic Opportunity**
- 5. Common Physical Traits**
- 6. Cultural similarity**

Factors Hindering Assimilation

- Physical Differences**
- Cultural Differences**
- Prejudice**
- Sense of superiority and inferiority**
- Domination and subordination**
- Isolation**

Competition

- Competition is one of the dissociative from of social processes.
- It is the most fundamental form of social struggle. It occurs whenever there is an insufficient supply of anything that human beings desire, insufficient in the sense that all cannot have as much of it as they wish.
- Ogburn and Nimkoff say that competition occurs when demand outturns supply.
- As E.S. Bogardus says. “Competition is a contest to obtain something which does not exist in quantity sufficient to meet the demand.”

Characteristics of Competition

❧ It is Universal:

- ❧ found in every society and in every age and in every group.
Universal struggle for existence.

❧ It is Impersonal:

- ❧ 'interaction without social contact.'
- ❧ do not compete with each other on a personal level.

❧ It is an Unconscious Activity:

- ❧ Achievement of goal or the reward is regarded as the main object of competitors.

❧ Continuous Process

- ❧ never comes to an end.
- ❧ It is not an intermittent process.

Forms of Competition

- Competition can be divided into many categories or forms. It exists everywhere but appears in many forms. They are:
 - ❑ economic competition,
 - ❑ cultural competition,
 - ❑ social competition,
 - ❑ racial competition,
 - ❑ political competition, etc.

Role of competition

Competition is considered to be a very healthy and necessary social process. It is indispensable in social life. It performs both positive and negative functions.

Positive functions

- (i) Assignment of the right individual to the proper place
- (ii) Source of motivation
- (iii) Conducive to progress

Negative functions

- (i) Competition may lead to frustration
- (ii) Competition may lead to monopoly
- (iii) Competition may lead to conflict

Conflict

Introduction

- The concept of conflict, being an outcome of behaviours, is an integral part of human life. Where ever there is interaction, there is conflict.
- Conflict can be considered as an expression of hostility (unfriendliness or opposition), negative attitudes, antagonism, aggression, rivalry and misunderstanding.



Definition

- According to J.H. Fitcher, “Conflict is the social process in which individual or groups seek their ends by directly challenging the antagonist by violence or threat of violence”.
- As K. Davis defines, “Conflict is a codified form of struggle”.
- According to A.W. Green, “Conflict is the deliberate attempt to oppose, resist or coerce the will of another or others”.
- Gillin and Gillin say, “Conflict is the social process in which individuals or groups seek their ends by directly challenging the antagonist by violence or threat of violence”.

How does conflict contribute to social change?

- **Highlighting Inequities and Injustices**
- **Challenging Existing Norms and Institutions**
- **Creating Awareness and Mobilizing Groups**
- **Promoting New Ideologies**
- **Accelerating Technological and Social Innovation**
- **Creating New Power Dynamics**
- **Promoting Legal and Political Reforms**

Role of Conflict

Positive Functions

- ✓ It promotes the solidarity and fellow-feeling.
- ✓ It enlarges the victorious group.
- ✓ It leads to redefinition of value system.
- ✓ It acts as a cementing factor in the establishment of intimate relations.
- ✓ It changes the relative status of the conflicting parties.

Negative Functions

- It causes social disorder, chaos and confusion.
- It disrupts social unity and cohesion.
- It causes a lot of psychological and moral damage.

**Can you think of a historical event where
conflict led to positive social change?**

How?

Distinction between Conflict & Competition



- 1) Conflict takes place on a conscious level, competition is unconscious.
- 2) conflict involves contact, competition does not.
- 3) Conflict may involve violence, competition is non-violent.
- 4) Conflict is personal, competition is impersonal activity.
- 5) Conflict lacks continuity, competition is a continuous process.
- 6) Conflict disregards social norms, competition does care for norms.
- 7) Conflict diverts members attention from group objectives, competition keeps members alert to the goal or objective.

Link of study materials

- <https://www.yourarticlelibrary.com/sociology/social-processes-the-meaning-types-characteristics-of-social-processes/8545>
- <https://egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/17115/1/Unit-3.pdf>